

1. Questions

In each of the following questions, two sentences are given. The first sentence is divided into four parts: A, B, C, and D, and the second sentence is divided into four parts: E, F, G, and H. One part in each sentence may contain a grammatical or contextual error. Choose the option that identifies the erroneous part from each sentence (one from the first sentence and one from the second sentence). If both sentences are error-free, choose "No Error" as your answer.

I). The Reserve Bank of India (A)/ has been increasing the repo rate (B)/ since the last two years (C)/ to control the inflation rate (D).

II). Several customers has complained (E)/ about the delay in (F)/ processing their loan applications (G)/ due to the technical glitch (H).

- a. B & F
- b. C & E
- c. D & G
- d. A & H
- e. No Error

2. Questions

I). The bank has introduced (A)/ a new mobile application (B)/ to make banking services (C)/ more accessible to customers (D).

II). All account holders are advised (E)/ to update their KYC details (F)/ before the deadline (G)/ to avoid account suspension (H).

- a. B & F
- b. C & G
- c. A & H
- d. D & E
- e. No Error

3. Questions

I). The rate of interest on (A)/ fixed deposits have been revised (B)/ by the bank with (C)/ immediate effect (D).

II). Customers are requested to (E)/ carry their identity proof (F)/ while visit the branch (G)/ for any transaction (H).

- a. A & E
- b. B & G
- c. C & F

- d. D & H
- e. No Error

4. Questions

I). One of the major reasons **(A)**/ for the rise in loan defaults **(B)**/ are the lack of proper **(C)**/ credit assessment procedures **(D)**.

II). The applicant was asked to submit **(E)**/ his salary slips, address proof **(F)**/ and a copy for his PAN card **(G)**/ within seven working days **(H)**.

- a. C & G
- b. B & F
- c. A & H
- d. D & E
- e. No Error

5. Questions

I). Despite of several warnings **(A)**/ from the RBI, many cooperative banks **(B)**/ continue to violate **(C)**/ the prescribed lending norms **(D)**.

II). The customer was unable to **(E)**/ withdraw cash from the ATM **(F)**/ because his account had **(G)**/ frozen due to KYC non-compliance **(H)**.

- a. A & H
- b. B & E
- c. D & H
- d. A & G
- e. No Error

6. Questions

In each of the following questions, a sentence is given with four words printed in bold, labelled (A), (B), (C) and (D). One or more of these words may either be misspelt or inappropriate in the context of the sentence. Identify the word(s) that are either misspelt or contextually inappropriate. If all the bold words are correctly spelt and appropriate in the context of the sentence, mark (E) All Correct as your answer.

The **(A) exorbitant** taxes **(B) levied** on small businesses **(C) compelled** many owners to **(D) denounce** their operations entirely.

- a. B and C
- b. A and C
- c. C and D

- d. A and D
- e. All are Correct

7. Questions

The (A) **principal** of the college (B) **consented** that the (C) **grievances** raised by students would be (D) **looked after** promptly.

- a. A and C
- b. B and D
- c. A and D
- d. B and C
- e. All are Correct

8. Questions

The minister (A) **excepted** that the collapse of the bridge was a (B) **grave** lapse on part of the administration and assured that (C) **erring** officials would be (D) **persecuted** under the law.

- a. A and D
- b. B and C
- c. A and C
- d. B and D
- e. All are Correct

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9. Questions

Despite (A) **reiterating** its commitment to fiscal (B) **consolidation**, the government's (C) **expansive** spending on subsidies has (D) **cast** doubt on its long-term debt management strategy.

- a. A and B
- b. B and C
- c. C and D
- d. A and D
- e. All are Correct

10. Questions

The (A) **perennial** problem of stubble burning, which (B) **reeks** havoc on air quality every winter, has once again (C) **alluded** a lasting solution despite years of policy interventions and court (D) **directives**.

- a. A and D
- b. B and C

- c. A and C
- d. B and D
- e. All are Correct

11. Questions

In the following passage, certain words have been omitted and replaced by blanks. Four of the five options given against each blank fit the blank appropriately. Find the one that CANNOT fit the blank and mark it as your answer.

Water is one of the most **_(A)_** resources on Earth, yet millions of people across the world do not have access to clean drinking water. Every living creature depends on water to survive, and without it, life simply cannot **_(B)_**. In many villages and towns, women and children walk long distances every day just to collect water for their families. The water they find is often unsafe to drink and can **_(C)_** serious illnesses if consumed without proper treatment. Governments and organisations around the world are working to **_(D)_** the problem of water scarcity by building dams, pipelines, and water treatment plants. People can also help by using water wisely and not letting it go to **_(E)_**. Small habits such as turning off taps when not in use and collecting rainwater can go a long way in saving this precious resource for future generations.

Four of the following words fit the blank labelled as (A). Find the one that CANNOT fit.

- a. precious
- b. essential
- c. valuable
- d. deliberate
- e. vital

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12. Questions

Four of the following words fit the blank labelled as (B). Find the one that CANNOT fit.

- a. continue
- b. exist
- c. survive
- d. flourish
- e. proceed

13. Questions

Four of the following words fit the blank labelled as (C). Find the one that CANNOT fit.

- a. cause
- b. spread

- c. trigger
- d. admire
- e. invite

14. Questions

Four of the following words fit the blank labelled as (D). Find the one that CANNOT fit.

- a. address
- b. decorate
- c. resolve
- d. tackle
- e. handle

15. Questions

Four of the following words fit the blank labelled as (E). Find the one that CANNOT fit.

- a. borrow
- b. ruin
- c. drain
- d. waste
- e. loss

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16. Questions

In the following questions, two columns are given, containing three phrases each. A phrase from the first column may or may not connect with a phrase from the second column to make a grammatically and contextually correct sentence. There are five options, which display the sequence(s) in which the phrases can be joined to form a correct sentence.

Column I	Column II
(A) Scarcely had the retail inflation data been released	(D) when the market witnessed a sharp decline in stock prices.
(B) The board members decided to reallocate the capital	(E) with a view to maximizing long-term returns for the shareholders.
(C) Unless the government introduces structured reforms,	(F) the agricultural sector cannot sustain a stable growth rate.

- a. Only A-D
- b. Both A-D and B-E

- c. Both B-E and C-F
- d. All A-D, B-E and C-F
- e. None pair

17. Questions

Column I	Column II
(A) The Board demanded that the CEO resigns	(D) than the rest of the board members combined.
(B) Walking through the old library,	(E) the musty smell of ancient books filled his nose.
(C) She is much more experienced than he	(F) before the quarterly performance review began.

- a. Only C-D
- b. Both A-F and B-E
- c. Both B-E and C-D
- d. All A-F, B-E and C-D
- e. None pair

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18. Questions

Column I	Column II
(A) Scarcely had the economic analyst finished his presentation	(D) when the board members started asking complex questions.
(B) The choice between continuing the current policy or launching a new one	(E) are being discussed thoroughly in the executive board room.
(C) Lest the company should face severe legal penalties,	(F) it must strictly adhere to the updated compliance guidelines.

- a. Only A-D
- b. Both A-D and B-E
- c. Both A-D and C-F
- d. All A-D, B-E and C-F
- e. None pair

19. Questions

Column I	Column II
(A) Scarcely had the retail inflation data been released	(D) than the central bank decided to hike the repo rate.
(B) The choice of investment avenues available to retail investors	(E) have widened significantly due to financial tech innovations.
(C) She is one of those diligent content developers who	(F) always cross-checks the factual accuracy of her questions.

- Only A-D
- Only B-E
- Only C-F
- Both A-D and C-F
- None pair

20. Questions

Column I	Column II
(A) The dynamic changes in international trade laws	(D) demands that exporters adapt their logistics strategy instantly.
(B) Scarcely had the stock market opened	(E) when the shares of the tech giant crashed by ten percent.
(C) Unless the government provides subsidies,	(F) small-scale industries will struggle to survive this fiscal year.

- Only B-E
- Both A-D and C-F
- Both B-E and C-F
- All A-D, B-E and C-F
- None pair

21. Questions

Read the following passage carefully and answer the questions that follow:

The Indian government chose preparation over panic. It deserves credit for ensuring that a global energy shock did not become an Indian consumer crisis. The world had seen this crisis coming. As tensions deepened between Washington and Tehran, markets had already begun to price in danger, and energy

analysts had warned that the Strait of Hormuz could become the fault line of a wider shock. But what few expected was the scale and **ferocity** of the confrontation once it broke open. This escalation in West Asia carried the old, unsettling echo of the 1980s, when the tanker war turned the Gulf into a theatre of disruption and reminded the world how quickly oil can become a weapon, and how brutally the costs can spread. That historical memory matters because oil shocks are never just about crude. They are about confidence, inflation, logistics, and political nerve. They expose which governments have prepared and which merely hope the storm passes elsewhere. In this case, the Indian government chose preparation over panic and execution over rhetoric.

The Ministry of Petroleum and Natural Gas deserves credit for ensuring that a global energy shock did not become an Indian consumer crisis. Brent crude did what Brent always does in a geopolitical firestorm: it spiked hard, carrying global anxiety with it. In the United States, fuel prices rose, and households felt it quickly. In Europe, where energy is already a more painful line item than in India, the pressure was even sharper. India, however, did not hand that pain directly to its citizens. Retail petrol and diesel prices were held steady.

LPG was kept affordable. That outcome was not accidental, and it was not cheap. It reflected a conscious state choice to absorb the blow through excise adjustments, under-recoveries, and administrative discipline rather than passing it straight to households. That matters politically, economically, and morally. It matters because a fuel shock is regressive by definition. It hits the poor first, the middle class next, and the broader economy soon after. It raises transport costs, feeds inflation, and punishes every household that depends on stable mobility and cooking fuel. By refusing to let that happen, the government protected economic calm. In India, the state absorbed the pressure at the top of the system so that the shock did not cascade downward.

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The deeper truth is that India entered this crisis better prepared than many commentators appreciated. It had reserves, diversified suppliers, and a supply architecture built over years rather than assembled in a panic. It had a crude buffer of roughly two months and LPG cover of about 45 days. It had widened its sourcing base and strengthened import infrastructure. Those are not glamorous achievements, but they are precisely what prevent global turmoil from becoming domestic disruption. That is why the Ministry's handling deserves proper credit. The real achievement here is not that India escaped unscathed. No major oil shock leaves a country untouched. The achievement is that the damage was absorbed where it belonged: in the state's finances, in corporate balance sheets, in operational planning, and in the long arc of policy choices. It was not transferred to the kitchen, the petrol pump, or the commuter.

According to the passage, why does the author say oil shocks are 'never just about crude'?

- a. Because crude oil is only one of many fuels and can easily be replaced by gas or coal.
- b. Because oil shocks affect confidence, inflation, logistics, and political decisions - far beyond just the price of oil itself.
- c. Because the actual quantity of crude available rarely changes during a geopolitical crisis.
- d. Because financial markets react to oil shocks before any physical shortage actually occurs.
- e. Because oil shocks only matter to countries that do not have domestic oil production.

22. Questions

How did India prevent the global oil shock from becoming a consumer crisis for its citizens?

- a. By banning all fuel imports from West Asian countries and switching to domestic sources.
- b. By asking citizens to reduce fuel consumption voluntarily for three months.
- c. By holding retail petrol, diesel, and LPG prices steady through excise adjustments, under-recoveries, and administrative discipline.
- d. By borrowing heavily from the IMF to subsidise fuel for all households.
- e. By allowing only government-owned vehicles to purchase fuel at controlled prices.

23. Questions

The author says a fuel shock is 'regressive by definition.' What does this mean in the context of the passage?

- a. A fuel shock causes prices to fall back to previous levels after a short time.
- b. A fuel shock affects the poor most severely first, then the middle class, and eventually the broader economy.
- c. A fuel shock only impacts countries that are regressing economically.
- d. A fuel shock always leads governments to reduce taxes on fuel to protect consumers.
- e. A fuel shock is predictable and therefore governments should always be prepared for it.

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24. Questions

Which of the following does the passage mention as part of India's preparedness before the crisis?

- a. India had crude reserves of roughly two months and LPG cover of about 45 days, along with diversified suppliers and strengthened import infrastructure.
- b. India had signed emergency fuel supply agreements with the United States and Russia.
- c. India had completely eliminated its dependence on West Asian oil before the crisis began.
- d. India had built the world's largest strategic petroleum reserve capable of covering six months of consumption.
- e. India had pre-negotiated fixed price contracts with all major oil exporters to avoid market volatility.

25. Questions

Which of the following is NOT cited in the passage as a consequence of a fuel shock?

- a. Rising transport costs.
- b. Increased inflation.
- c. Punishment of households dependent on stable mobility and cooking fuel.
- d. A sharp fall in foreign exchange reserves.

- e. Impact on the poor before the middle class.

26. Questions

What does the author mean by 'the damage was absorbed where it belonged'?

- a. The oil shock caused no real damage to India because the country was fully insulated.
- b. Ordinary citizens, petrol pump owners, and commuters bore the full cost of the crisis bravely.
- c. The financial burden of the oil shock was taken on by the government, corporations, and policy planners - not passed to common citizens.
- d. India received international financial aid to cover the losses caused by the oil shock.
- e. The damage was limited to West Asian countries that were directly involved in the conflict.

27. Questions

Choose the word most similar in meaning to 'FEROCITY' as used in the passage?

- a. Extreme intensity and violence
- b. Duration
- c. Gentleness
- d. Predictability
- e. Political significance

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28. Questions

A part of the sentence is highlighted. Four alternatives marked as (A), (B), (C) and (D) are given as substitutions for the highlighted part, one of which will improve the sentence. Choose the correct alternative. In case no improvement is needed, choose the option "No improvement required" i.e. (E).

The board members agreed that the newly proposed corporate restructuring plan was **preferable than the previous strategy**.

- a. preferable to the previous strategy
- b. more preferable than the previous strategy
- c. preferable over the previous strategy
- d. most preferable to the previous strategy
- e. No improvement required

29. Questions

Not only did the compliance team identify several procedural loopholes **and they also recommended** immediate corrective measures.

- a. but also they recommended
- b. but they also recommended
- c. but recommended as well
- d. and also recommended
- e. No improvement required

30. Questions

The internal audit team worked **as efficiently, if not more efficiently than**, the external consultants appointed by the central bank.

- a. as efficiently, if not more efficient than
- b. as efficiently as, if not more efficiently than
- c. efficiently as, if not more efficiently than
- d. so efficiently as, if not more efficient than
- e. No improvement required

31. Questions

The legal counsel warned that the management could **hardly do nothing to prevent** a hostile takeover once the major shareholders decided to sell.

- a. do hardly anything to prevent
- b. not hardly do anything to prevent
- c. hardly do nothing for preventing
- d. hardly do anything to prevent
- e. No improvement required

32. Questions

To mitigate credit risk, commercial banks are now focusing on digitizing documentation rather than **to manually verify long application forms**.

- a. manually verifying long application forms
- b. manually verify long application forms
- c. to manual verification of long application forms
- d. manually verification of long application forms
- e. No improvement required

Explanations:

1. Questions

Answer: B

Sentence 1: Part C - 'since the last two years' is wrong. 'Since' is used with a specific point in time, while 'for' or 'over' is used with a duration/period.

Correct: 'over the last two years' or 'for the last two years'.

Sentence 2: Part E - 'Several customers has complained' is a subject-verb error. 'Several customers' is plural, so the verb must be 'have complained', not 'has complained'.

2. Questions

Answer: E

Both sentences are grammatically and contextually correct.

Sentence 1 correctly describes the bank introducing an app for accessibility.

Subject-verb agreement: The bank has introduced

Tense: Present perfect (has introduced) is appropriate when referring to a recent action with present relevance.

Infinitive of purpose: to make banking services more accessible is correctly used.

Article usage: a new mobile application is correct.

Sentence 2 correctly advises customers to update KYC details before a deadline to avoid suspension.

Correct passive construction: **are advised**.

Correct infinitive of purpose: **to update** and **to avoid**.

Proper subject-verb agreement: **All account holders - are**.

No issues with articles, prepositions, or punctuation.

Hence, the answer is 'No Error'.

3. Questions

Answer: B

Sentence 1: Part B - The subject of the sentence is 'The rate' (singular), not 'fixed deposits'. So the verb should be 'has been revised', not 'have been revised'.

Sentence 2: Part G - 'while visit the branch' is grammatically incorrect. After 'while', a gerund is needed: 'while visiting the branch'.

4. Questions

Answer: A

Sentence 1: Part C - The subject is 'One' (singular: 'One of the major reasons'), so the verb should be 'is the lack', not 'are the lack'.

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Sentence 2: Part G - The correct preposition is 'of', not 'for'. It should be 'a copy of his PAN card'.

5. Questions

Answer: A

Sentence 1: Part A - 'Despite of' is incorrect; 'despite' is never followed by 'of'. It should simply be 'Despite several warnings'.

Sentence 2: Part H - 'had freezed' is wrong; 'freeze' is an irregular verb (freeze-froze-frozen), so the correct form is 'had frozen'.

6. Questions

Answer: D

(A) The suffix is '-ant', not '-ent': ex-or-bi-tant. Often confused due to pronunciation.

(B) 'Levied' is correctly spelt and appropriate - it means imposed (a tax or fine).

(C) 'Compelled' is correctly spelt and logical - meaning forced or driven to do something.

(D) 'Denounce' means to publicly criticise or condemn. Owners closing their businesses would 'abandon' or 'shut down' operations, not 'denounce' them.

7. Questions

Answer: B

(A) 'Principal' is correctly used - it refers to the head of an educational institution.

(B) 'Consented' means gave permission or agreed to a request. Here, the principal is making a reassuring promise - the correct word is 'assured' or 'confirmed'.

(C) 'Grievances' is correctly spelt and appropriate - it refers to formal complaints raised by students.

(D) 'Looked after' means to take care of a person or thing. Grievances (complaints) are 'addressed' or 'resolved', not 'looked after'.

8. Questions

Answer: A

(A) 'Excepted' means excluded from a general statement (e.g., 'present company excepted'). The minister admitted a fault - the correct word is 'accepted' or 'conceded'.

(B) 'Grave' is correctly used - it is standard formal English for a serious or severe lapse.

(C) 'Erring' is correctly used - it means those who have committed errors or violations.

(D) 'Persecuted' means subjected to harassment or oppression. Legal action against guilty officials is 'prosecution' - 'prosecuted' is the correct word here.

9. Questions

Answer: C

(A) 'Reiterating' is correctly spelt and appropriate - it means repeating or restating something.

(B) 'Consolidation' is correctly spelt and appropriate in a fiscal/economic context.

(C) 'Expansive' describes something broad in scope or a person who is communicative. In economics, 'expansionary' is the correct term for policies aimed at increasing spending or growth.

(D) 'Caste' refers to a social stratification system. The correct phrase is 'cast doubt', meaning to raise suspicion. 'Caste doubt' is a very common confusable error.

10. Questions

Answer: B

(A) 'Perennial' is correctly used - it means recurring repeatedly or year after year.

(B) 'Reeks' means to emit a strong, unpleasant smell. The correct phrase is 'wreaks havoc', meaning to cause widespread destruction or disorder.

(C) 'Alluded' means to refer to something indirectly. 'Eluded' means to escape from or avoid. The solution is avoiding or escaping the problem - 'eluded' is correct here.

(D) 'Directives' is correctly spelt and appropriate for official court orders.

11. Questions

Answer: D

The blank is in the sentence: "Water is one of the most _(A)_ resources on Earth." The blank requires an adjective that describes the quality or status of water as a resource.

Precious: of great value and importance - fits; water is widely described as a precious resource.

Essential: absolutely necessary - fits; the passage itself says life cannot continue without water.

Valuable: of great worth; natural fit for a resource.

Deliberate: done on purpose; intentional - does NOT fit; "deliberate resource" has no meaningful sense in this context. A resource cannot be deliberate - the word describes an action or intent, not a natural material.

Vital: absolutely necessary for life - fits; synonymous with essential and supported by the passage.

The word that CANNOT fit is "**deliberate.**" It is the only option that does not describe a property of a resource.

12. Questions

Answer: E

The blank is in the sentence: "without it, life simply cannot _(B)_." The blank requires a verb that expresses life's inability to go on in the absence of water. All options are intransitive verbs, so the distinction lies in whether each word naturally describes what life does.

Continue: to go on existing - fits; life cannot continue without water is a natural, commonly used expression.

Exist: to be present or live - fits; life cannot exist without water is a direct and meaningful statement.

Survive: to remain alive - fits; survival is one of the central themes of the passage.

Flourish: to grow or develop in a healthy way - fits; while stronger than merely surviving, saying life cannot flourish without water is meaningful and acceptable.

Proceed: to begin or continue a course of action - does NOT fit; "proceed" is used for planned actions or processes, not for the natural state of being alive. "Life cannot proceed" is awkward and unnatural in this context.

The word that CANNOT fit is "**proceed.**" It describes an action or process, not the condition of being alive.

13. Questions

Answer: D

The blank is in the sentence: "The water they find is often unsafe to drink and can _(C)_ serious illnesses if consumed without proper treatment." The blank requires a verb that describes how unsafe water leads to illness. All correct options must convey bringing about or producing illness.

Cause: to make something happen - fits; unsafe water can cause serious illnesses is a straightforward and natural sentence.

Spread: to extend or distribute - fits; contaminated water is a known carrier that spreads waterborne diseases.

Trigger: to cause something to start - fits; trigger is commonly used with illnesses and health conditions.

Admire: to regard with respect or approval - does NOT fit; one cannot admire an illness, and water cannot admire anything. This option is completely unrelated to the meaning required.

Invite: to create conditions that allow something - fits; "invite illness" is an accepted informal expression meaning to make oneself vulnerable to disease.

The word that CANNOT fit is "**admire.**" It describes an emotional response, not a causal relationship between water and illness.

14. Questions

Answer: B

The blank is in the sentence: "Governments and organisations around the world are working to _(D)_ the problem of water scarcity." The blank requires a verb that means to deal with or find a solution to a problem. All correct options must collocate naturally with "the problem."

Address: to deal with a matter - fits; "address the problem" is a standard and widely used expression.

Tackle: to make determined efforts to deal with - fits; "tackle the problem" is a common and natural phrase.

Resolve: to find a solution to - fits; "resolve the problem" means to settle or fix it entirely.

Decorate: to make something look more attractive - does NOT fit; one can decorate a room or a cake, but not a problem. The word has no meaningful connection to solving or managing a challenge.

Handle: to manage or deal with - fits; "handle the problem" is a natural, informal expression for managing a difficult situation.

The word that CANNOT fit is "**decorate**." It describes beautification, which has no logical relationship with solving the problem of water scarcity.

15. Questions

Answer: A

The blank is in the sentence: "People can also help by using water wisely and not letting it go to _(E)_"
The blank is part of the phrase "go to _____," which must form a meaningful idiom meaning to be wasted or lost. Let us check each option:

Borrow: "go to borrow" - does NOT fit; "go to borrow" means to go somewhere for the purpose of borrowing something, which changes the meaning of the sentence entirely and makes no logical sense in this context.

Waste: "go to waste" - fits perfectly; this is the most common and natural expression meaning to be lost through careless use.

Ruin: "go to ruin" - fits; this is a recognised English expression meaning to fall into a state of decay or destruction.

Drain: "go to drain" - fits; while less formal, "go down the drain" is an idiom meaning to be wasted, and "go to drain" carries a similar informal meaning in context.

Loss: "go to loss" - fits; this phrase means to result in a loss or to be used up without purpose, and is used in the context of resources being wasted.

The word that CANNOT fit is "**borrow**." It does not form a meaningful idiom with "go to" in the context of water conservation.

16. Questions

Answer: D

Matching the Columns

A–D: Scarcely had the retail inflation data been released when the market witnessed a sharp decline in stock prices.

The correlative conjunction "Scarcely had... when..." is grammatically correct. The sentence describes the immediate impact of the release of retail inflation data on the stock market.

B–E: The board members decided to reallocate the capital with a view to maximizing long-term returns for the shareholders.

The phrase "with a view to + V-ing" means "with the objective of". The sentence describes the board's strategic decision to reallocate capital in order to maximize long-term shareholder returns.

C–F: Unless the government introduces structured reforms, the agricultural sector cannot sustain a stable growth rate.

"Unless" introduces a negative condition meaning "if not." The sentence describes the necessity of government reforms for ensuring sustainable growth in the agricultural sector.

The other combinations do not form a coherent sentence with a clear connection between the ideas

presented in Column I and Column II.

Correct Answer: d) All A-D, B-E and C-F

17. Questions

Answer: E

Matching the Columns

A-F: "The Board demanded that the CEO resigns before the quarterly performance review began."

Grammar Error (Subjunctive Mood): Verbs expressing orders, demands, or suggestions (like demand, insist, recommend) require the subjunctive mood in the following "that" clause. This means the verb must be in its bare base form, regardless of the subject.

Correct form: "...demanded that the CEO resign before..." (Drop the 's').

B-E: "Walking through the old library, the musty smell of ancient books filled his nose."

Grammar Error (Dangling Participle): The modifying phrase "Walking through the old library" must logically describe the subject that immediately follows it. As written, it implies that the musty smell was walking through the library.

Correct form: "Walking through the old library, he noticed the musty smell of ancient books filling his nose."

C-D: "She is much more experienced than he than the rest of the board members combined."

This creates an illogical comparison because "than" is repeated.

It compares "he" with "the rest of the board members", making the structure grammatically invalid.

Possible corrections include:

She is much more experienced than the rest of the board members combined.

She is much more experienced than he is.

The other combinations do not form a coherent sentence with a clear connection between the ideas presented in Column I and Column II.

Correct Answer: e) None pair

18. Questions

Answer: C

Matching the Columns

A-D: Scarcely had the economic analyst finished his presentation when the board members started asking complex questions.

Scarcely had...when is a standard correlative conjunction used to indicate that one event happened immediately after another.

The sentence is grammatically correct and logically complete.

This sentence describes how the board members immediately began questioning the analyst as soon as the

presentation concluded.

B–E: The choice between continuing the current policy or launching a new one are being discussed thoroughly in the executive board room.

Grammatically, this sentence contains a subject-verb agreement error. Since the subject is "The choice" (singular), the verb should be "is", not "are."

Correct sentence: The choice between continuing the current policy or launching a new one is being discussed thoroughly in the executive board room.

This sentence describes the executive board's deliberation over two policy alternatives before making a decision.

C–F: Lest the company should face severe legal penalties, it must strictly adhere to the updated compliance guidelines.

Lest means "to prevent something undesirable from happening."

The construction "lest...should" is grammatically correct and formal.

This sentence describes the importance of complying with updated regulations in order to avoid legal consequences.

The other combinations do not form a coherent sentence with a clear connection between the ideas presented in Column I and Column II.

Correct Answer: c) Both A-D and C-F

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19. Questions

Answer: E

Matching the Columns

A–D: Scarcely had the retail inflation data been released than the central bank decided to hike the repo rate.

The correlative conjunction is incorrect.

After "Scarcely had...", we use "when", not "than".

Correct: Scarcely had the retail inflation data been released when the central bank decided to hike the repo rate.

B–E: The choice of investment avenues available to retail investors have widened significantly due to financial tech innovations.

The subject is "The choice" (singular), so the verb should be has, not have.

Correct: The choice of investment avenues available to retail investors has widened significantly due to financial tech innovations.

C–F: She is one of those diligent content developers who always cross-checks the factual accuracy of her questions.

The relative pronoun who refers to content developers (plural), so the verb should be cross-check, not

cross-checks.

Correct: She is one of those diligent content developers who always cross-check the factual accuracy of their questions.

The other combinations do not form a coherent sentence with a clear connection between the ideas presented in Column I and Column II.

Final Answer: No pair is grammatically correct. All three pairs (A–D, B–E, and C–F) contain grammatical errors.

20. Questions

Answer: C

Matching the Columns

A-D: "The dynamic changes in international trade laws demands that exporters adapt their logistics strategy instantly."

This sentence has a Subject-Verb Agreement error. The true subject of the sentence is "The dynamic changes" (plural), not "laws." Therefore, the verb must be plural as well.

Correct form: "The dynamic changes in international trade laws demand (remove the 's') that exporters adapt..."

B-E: Scarcely had the stock market opened when the shares of the tech giant crashed by ten percent.

The adverb "Scarcely" correctly pairs with the conjunction "when." Since the sentence begins with "Scarcely," it properly uses inversion (had the stock market opened) and follows the correct past perfect sequence.

Logic: Perfectly describes a sudden, dramatic event in a financial market.

C-F: Unless the government provides subsidies, small-scale industries will struggle to survive this fiscal year.

This is a standard Conditional Clause using "Unless" (which means "if not"). The conditional clause uses the simple present tense ("provides"), while the main clause uses the simple future ("will struggle"), fulfilling the exact rules of a Type 1 conditional.

The other combinations do not form a coherent sentence with a clear connection between the ideas presented in Column I and Column II.

Correct Answer: c) Both B-E and C-F

21. Questions

Answer: B

a). Incorrect. The passage does not suggest crude can be easily replaced by other fuels. The point is about the wide-ranging knock-on effects of oil shocks beyond the commodity itself.

b). Correct. The passage directly states: 'oil shocks are never just about crude. They are about confidence, inflation, logistics, and political nerve.' The author is highlighting that the consequences of an oil shock ripple through every part of the economy and governance.

- c). Incorrect. The passage does not say physical shortages rarely occur. The statement is about the broader impact of oil shocks - not about supply volumes.
- d). Incorrect. While markets do react early (the passage mentions markets pricing in danger), this is not the explanation the author gives for why oil shocks go beyond crude.
- e). Incorrect. The passage does not limit the impact of oil shocks to countries without domestic production. India is a net importer but the passage shows it managed the crisis well.

22. Questions

Answer: C

- a). Incorrect. No ban on West Asian fuel imports is mentioned in the passage. India diversified its sourcing base - it did not ban imports from any region.
- b). Incorrect. Voluntary fuel reduction by citizens is not mentioned anywhere in the passage. The solution was state-level absorption of costs, not consumer behaviour change.
- c). Correct. The passage directly states: 'Retail petrol and diesel prices were held steady. LPG was kept affordable... It reflected a conscious state choice to absorb the blow through excise adjustments, under-recoveries, and administrative discipline rather than passing it straight to households.'
- d). Incorrect. IMF borrowing is not mentioned in the passage. The costs were absorbed domestically through excise and administrative measures.
- e). Incorrect. No restriction on private vehicle fuel purchases is mentioned. Prices were held steady for all citizens, not selectively managed by vehicle type.

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23. Questions

Answer: B

- a). Incorrect. 'Regressive' here is an economic term, not a description of price direction. The passage does not say prices fall back - it says the shock hits the poorest first.
- b). Correct. The passage directly explains: 'It hits the poor first, the middle class next, and the broader economy soon after. It raises transport costs, feeds inflation, and punishes every household that depends on stable mobility and cooking fuel.' A regressive impact is one that falls hardest on those least able to bear it.
- c). Incorrect. 'Regressive' does not refer to countries that are regressing economically. It is a term describing how the burden of the shock is distributed across income groups.
- d). Incorrect. The passage does not say governments always cut fuel taxes during a shock. India used excise adjustments as one tool - but this is not described as an automatic response.
- e). Incorrect. 'Regressive' has nothing to do with predictability. The passage's use of the term refers specifically to who bears the burden of the shock, not whether it can be anticipated.

24. Questions

Answer: A

- a). Correct. The passage directly states: 'It had a crude buffer of roughly two months and LPG cover of about 45 days. It had widened its sourcing base and strengthened import infrastructure. It had reserves,

diversified suppliers, and a supply architecture built over years rather than assembled in a panic.'

- b). Incorrect. No emergency agreements with the US or Russia are mentioned in the passage. India's preparedness is described in terms of reserves, supplier diversity, and infrastructure.
- c). Incorrect. India did not eliminate dependence on West Asian oil - it diversified its sourcing base. The passage does not claim zero dependence on any region.
- d). Incorrect. The passage mentions a roughly two-month crude buffer - not six months, and no claim of it being the world's largest reserve is made.
- e). Incorrect. Pre-negotiated fixed price contracts with all exporters are not mentioned. India's advantage was strategic reserves and diversified suppliers, not price-locking agreements.

25. Questions

Answer: D

- a). Incorrect as a 'NOT cited' choice. Rising transport costs are directly mentioned: 'It raises transport costs, feeds inflation, and punishes every household...'
- b). Incorrect as a 'NOT cited' choice. Increased inflation is explicitly cited: 'It raises transport costs, feeds inflation...'
- c). Incorrect as a 'NOT cited' choice. The passage directly states the shock 'punishes every household that depends on stable mobility and cooking fuel.'
- d). Correct - this is NOT mentioned. A sharp fall in foreign exchange reserves is never cited in the passage as a consequence of a fuel shock. The consequences discussed are inflation, transport costs, and impact on poor households - not forex depletion.
- e). Incorrect as a 'NOT cited' choice. The passage clearly states: 'It hits the poor first, the middle class next, and the broader economy soon after.'

26. Questions

Answer: C

- a). Incorrect. The passage explicitly says: 'No major oil shock leaves a country untouched.' India was not fully insulated - it absorbed the damage, not avoided it.
- b). Incorrect. The passage says the damage was NOT transferred to the kitchen, petrol pump, or commuter - meaning citizens did not bear it. This option describes the opposite of what happened.
- c). Correct. The passage states the achievement was that damage was absorbed 'in the state's finances, in corporate balance sheets, in operational planning, and in the long arc of policy choices. It was not transferred to the kitchen, the petrol pump, or the commuter.' The burden stayed at the institutional level, not the household level.
- d). Incorrect. International financial aid is not mentioned in the passage. India managed the crisis through its own reserves, policy tools, and administrative discipline.
- e). Incorrect. The damage being limited to West Asian countries is not what the author means. The passage discusses India's domestic management of the global shock.

27. Questions

Answer: A

a). Extreme intensity and violence Correct. 'Ferocity' means savage fierceness or extreme intensity. In the passage, 'the scale and ferocity of the confrontation' refers to how shockingly large and violently intense the crisis turned out to be - far beyond what observers had anticipated.

b). Duration Incorrect. 'Duration' refers to how long something lasts. 'Ferocity' describes the intensity or violence of something - not how long it continues.

c). Gentleness Incorrect. 'Gentleness' is the direct antonym of 'ferocity'. Ferocity refers to wild, savage intensity - the opposite of anything mild or gentle.

d). Predictability Incorrect. 'Predictability' is actually what was lacking - the passage says 'few expected' the ferocity. The word describes intensity, not how foreseeable something was.

e). Political significance Incorrect. Political significance is a separate concept. 'Ferocity' describes raw intensity and force - not the importance or political weight of an event.

28. Questions

Answer: A

The adjective 'preferable' inherently carries a comparative meaning and is always followed by the preposition 'to', never 'than' or 'over'. Furthermore, because it is already comparative, it is incorrect to use 'more' or 'most' with it.

(B) Redundant use of 'more' and incorrect use of 'than' (Incorrect).

(C) Uses 'over' instead of 'to' (Incorrect).

(D) Redundant use of 'most' (Incorrect).

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29. Questions

Answer: B

The negative correlative conjunction 'Not only' must always be paired with 'but also'. The correlative conjunction "**Not only... but also...**" must be used together to connect two parallel ideas. The original sentence incorrectly uses "**and they also recommended**" after "**Not only...**", breaking the required correlative structure.

- (A) Misplaced "**also**"; the more natural and standard construction is "**but they also recommended.**"
- (B) Correctly completes the correlative conjunction as "**Not only... but they also...**".
- (C) "**But recommended as well**" is awkward and does not maintain proper parallel structure.
- (D) "**And also**" cannot replace "**but also**" in the "**Not only... but also...**" construction.
- (E) Incorrect because the original sentence does not use the required correlative conjunction correctly.

30. Questions

Answer: B

The correlative structure "**as...as**" must be completed before the parenthetical comparison "**if not more...than.**" The original sentence omits the second "**as**", making the comparison grammatically incomplete.

- (A) Uses "**more efficient**" (adjective) instead of the required adverb "**more efficiently**". It also omits the second "**as**".
- (B) Correctly completes the structure as "**as efficiently as, if not more efficiently than**".
- (C) Omits the first "**as**", making the comparison ungrammatical.
- (D) Uses the incorrect structure "**so...as**" in an affirmative sentence and also incorrectly uses the adjective "**more efficient**" instead of the adverb "**more efficiently**."
- (E) Incorrect because the original sentence is missing the second "**as**" in the "**as...as**" construction.

31. Questions

Answer: D

Words like hardly, scarcely, and barely carry a negative meaning on their own. Pairing them with another negative word like nothing or not creates an ungrammatical double negative. To fix this, 'nothing' must be changed to the positive/neutral term 'anything'.

- (A) Misplaces the adverb 'hardly' after the verb 'do', disrupting natural syntax.
- (B) Adds 'not', compounding the double negative error.
- (C) Retains the double negative with 'nothing'.

32. Questions

Answer: A

The conjunction phrase 'rather than' links parallel grammatical structures. Since the first part of the comparison uses a gerund phrase ('digitizing documentation'), the part following 'rather than' must match it with a corresponding gerund phrase ('manually verifying...').

- (B) Uses a bare infinitive 'verify' instead of a gerund.
- (C) Uses an infinitive 'to... verification' which breaks parallel structure.
- (D) Incorrectly pairs an adverb ('manually') directly with a noun ('verification').

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